Incident Response Report - Phishing Attack Investigation

Avinash Shankar P T
Cyber Security Intern

1. Executive Summary

A phishing attack targeted employees using a spoofed email containing a malicious link designed to steal credentials. The SOC team detected the activity, isolated affected systems, and mitigated the threat. No confirmed data breach occurred.

2. Timeline

Timestamp	Event
2025-08-18 13:50	Phishing email received
2025-08-18 14:00	User clicked malicious link
2025-08-18 14:05	Alert generated in Wazuh
2025-08-18 14:10	Endpoint isolated
2025-08-18 14:30	Memory dump collected
2025-08-18 15:00	IOC analysis completed

3. Impact Analysis

- Affected Users: 2–3
- Systems Impacted: Endpoints
- Threat Type: Phishing
- Data Exposure: None
- Business Impact: Minimal

4. Remediation Steps

- Isolated endpoints
- Blocked malicious links
- Reset passwords
- Performed malware scan
- Updated email filters

5. Lessons Learned

- Improve user awareness
- Enable MFA
- Improve email filtering
- Automate alerts

Investigation Log

Timestamp	Action
2026-03-18 14:00:00	Isolated endpoint
2026-03-18 14:10:00	Captured system logs
2026-03-18 14:30:00	Collected memory dump
2026-03-18 14:45:00	Analyzed email headers
2026-03-18 15:00:00	Checked malicious URL

Phishing Checklist

☐ **Confirm email headers**

☐ **Check sender domain authenticity**

☐ **Verify link reputation (VirusTotal)**

☐ **Identify affected users**

☐ **Block malicious domain/IP**

☐ **Reset user credentials**

☐ **Scan endpoint for malware**

Post-Mortem

The incident highlighted gaps in user awareness and email filtering mechanisms. Faster detection and response minimized impact. Implementing stronger phishing protection, improving monitoring, and conducting regular user training will enhance overall security posture and reduce the likelihood of similar incidents in the future.